

BRAHMOS – The Ultimate Weapon of Deterrence

The power and lethality of precision strike weapons in modern warfare has increased manifold owing to their ability to annihilate enemy positions with accuracy, speed and firepower. Among worldwide precision strike weapons, supersonic cruise missile BRAHMOS rules the roost by combining impeccable speed, precision, firepower, versatility, stealth and range. Designed and developed by India's DRDO and Russia's NPOM, BRAHMOS has established itself as the "choicest deterrent system" of 21st century.

The operationalisation of the tactical missile in the Tri-Services of India has made it the first and only country in the world to possess "supersonic cruise missile triad."

The state-of-the-art missile based on cutting-edge technologies, superior design parameters and advanced features, has validated its lethality to neutralise high-value, heavily fortified ground and sea-based targets from land, sea and air platforms from 'stand-off' ranges in day-and-night, all-weather conditions. The missile can be swiftly mobilised and actively deployed in conflict zones at a very short notice.

India-Russia JV enterprise BrahMos Aerospace has designed, developed, tested and successfully delivered BRAHMOS to the Indian Armed Forces in land-to-land, land-to-sea, sea-to-land, land-

to-sea, air-to-land and air-to-sea configurations. The induction of the multi-role, multi-platform weapon has enormously bolstered India's capability to undertake joint, network-centric warfare operations of present times.

Keeping pace with 'Make-In-India' endeavours, BrahMos Aerospace, in close coordination with DRDO, has raised indigenisation content of the missile by steadily incorporating indigenous technologies, components and systems. The defence industrial partners associated with the JV have been majorly contributing towards this end.

"In close cooperation with DRDO, our defence industrial partners and all other stakeholders associated with the JV, we have upgraded BRAHMOS and validated its superior functional and operational features. The increased indigenous content in the weapon system has reduced its overall production, operational and maintenance costs," says Shri Atul D Rane, Director General, BrahMos, DRDO and CEO & MD, BrahMos Aerospace.

On January 28, 2022, the JV entity charted yet another historic milestone by signing an export contract with the Republic of Philippines to deliver shore-based BRAHMOS anti-ship missile system to the Armed Forces of Philippines.

The landmark order positioned BRAHMOS as India's first full-scale major weapon system set for delivery

to a friendly, foreign customer nation, thereby fulfilling the farsighted 'Mind-to-Market' strategy of the JV programme.

To retain its supremacy as a world-class system well into the future, BrahMos JV has also started working on the more advanced BRAHMOS-NG (next-gen) variant. The new smaller, lighter missile would be designed for installation onboard a wider number of modern military platforms on land, sea, underwater and air in more numbers, thereby further widening its scope and outreach in the modern warfare domain.

